

UPSC Intel · Daily Brief

TUESDAY, 29 SEPTEMBER 2026

22 must-know stories, 23 Prelims facts, 15 editorials and 12 explainers, picked from 922 stories reported. Each item links to its source; notes quote the reports.

[Open this brief online: summaries, Ask Intel and practice MCQs](#)

MUST-KNOW

High-yield stories: make notes on these. Grouped by syllabus area.

Polity & Constitution

GS2

MAKE NOTES

Supreme Court quashes NSA detention of Sambhal violence accused, slaps Rs. 10 lakh costs on U.P. govt.

The Supreme Court quashed the National Security Act detention of Mulla Afroz, accused of masterminding the 2024 Sambhal violence. The trigger was an appeal filed by Afroz against the Allahabad High Court judgment that had upheld his preventive detention. The core issue debated was whether an alleged confessional statement made in police custody can form the sole ground for preventive detention. A Bench comprising Justice Dipankar Datta and Justice Sheel Nagu held that an alleged confession cannot be the sole ground for detention. The Court ruled that surrounding circumstances must be looked into and found that the detaining authority failed to consider appropriate material. The Supreme Court concluded that the power of detention had been illegally exercised by the authorities. The Court set aside the detention order, the confirmation order, and the Allahabad High Court judgment upholding the detention. The Court additionally imposed costs of Rs. 10 lakh on the State of Uttar Pradesh for the illegal detention.

When: 2026-09-29 · **Where:** Sambhal, Uttar Pradesh · **Who:** Mulla Afroz, Justice Dipankar Datta, Justice Sheel Nagu · **Prelims:** Mulla Afroz was accused of being the alleged mastermind of the November 2024 Sambhal violence.; The Sambhal District Magistrate passed the preventive detention order under Section 3 of the NSA on October 13, 2025.; The Supreme Court imposed costs of Rs. 10 lakh on the State of Uttar Pradesh.

Why it matters — Reiterates strict judicial scrutiny over the executive's use of stringent preventive detention laws.; Clarifies that custodial confessional statements cannot serve as the sole basis for subjective satisfaction under the NSA.

Static — Preventive detention involves detaining a person to prevent them from committing future crimes, rather than punishing them for a past crime. The National Security Act (NSA), 1980 empowers the Central and State governments to detain individuals to prevent them from acting in a manner prejudicial to national security or public order. Under the NSA, an individual can be detained without charges for up to 12 months, though the grounds must be communicated and advisory boards must review the case.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment

[Bar & Bench: read the source](#) · also reported by [Hindustan Times](#), [The New Indian Express](#), [rediff.com](#), [Times of India](#)

GS2

MAKE NOTES

Supreme Court Refers Seniority Criteria in Higher Judicial Services to Constitution Bench in All India Judges Association Case. Amicus Curiae's Application Seeks to Address Disparity in Career Progression Between Direct Recruits and Promotees, Leading to

An application by the Amicus Curiae highlighting career progression disparities between direct recruits and promotees brought the issue before the Supreme Court. The Supreme Court referred the question of seniority criteria in Higher Judicial Services to a Constitution Bench, acting on an application by the Amicus Curiae in the All India Judges Association case.

When: 2026-09-29 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Supreme Court, Amicus Curiae · **Prelims:** The matter was referred in the All India Judges Association case.; The referral addresses seniority criteria in Higher Judicial Services.; An application was filed by the Amicus Curiae.

Why it matters — It addresses long-standing grievances regarding career stagnation and promotional disparities among judicial officers.; A Constitution Bench ruling will provide a definitive legal precedent governing judicial seniority across India.

Static — Constitution Benches of the Supreme Court consist of at least five judges, set up under Article 145(3) of the Constitution to decide substantial questions of law involving the interpretation of the Constitution. The Higher Judicial Service comprises district judges and forms an integral part of the state judicial machinery under Article 233 of the Constitution. Recruitment to the Higher Judicial Service is conducted through direct recruitment from the bar and promotion from subordinate judicial services.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment

[Lawtext: read the source](#)

GS2

MAKE NOTES

Collegium picks Delhi high court chief justice, 2 others as SC judges

The Supreme Court collegium recommended the appointment of three high court chief justices as judges of the Supreme Court. The recommendation was made by a collegium comprising Chief Justice of India Surya Kant and Justices Vikram Nath, B V Nagarathna, M M Sundresh, and P S Narasimha. The three recommended judges are Justices Sunita Agarwal, Devendra Kumar Upadhyay, and Aparesh Kumar Singh. Upon acceptance of these recommendations, the working strength of the Supreme Court will increase to 37 judges against a sanctioned strength of 38. Justice Sunita Agarwal's elevation will increase the total strength of women judges in the Supreme Court to two. With Justices Agarwal and Upadhyay having Allahabad High Court as their parent high court, Allahabad's representation in the apex court will rise to four. Justice Sunita Agarwal became the Chief Justice of Gujarat High Court in July 2023 after being appointed to Allahabad High Court in November 2011. Justice Devendra Kumar Upadhyay was appointed Chief Justice of Delhi High Court in January 2025 and previously served as Chief Justice of Bombay High Court.

When: 2026-09-29 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** CJI Surya Kant, Justice Sunita Agarwal, Justice Devendra Kumar Upadhyay, Justice Aparesh Kumar Singh · **Prelims:** Sanctioned strength of the Supreme Court is 38 judges.; Justices Sunita Agarwal, Devendra Kumar Upadhyay, and Aparesh Kumar Singh were recommended for elevation.; Justice Sunita Agarwal became Chief Justice of Gujarat HC in July 2023.

Why it matters — Elevates the working strength of the Supreme Court closer to its sanctioned capacity of 38.; Increases the representation of women judges in the apex court to two.

Static — The Supreme Court Collegium is a body that decides on the appointment and transfer of judges to the Supreme Court and high courts, drawing its authority from judicial precedents rather than a specific constitutional provision. The collegium system evolved through the Three Judges Cases (1981, 1993, and 1998), establishing that the Chief Justice of India must consult a collegium of senior-most judges for appointments. Under Article 124 of the Constitution, Supreme Court judges are appointed by the President after consultation with the CJI and other judges as deemed necessary.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment

[Times of India: read the source](#)

Governance & Policy

GS2 GS3

MAKE NOTES

Cabinet approves Rs 23,731-crore GOBARDhan Scheme to scale up compressed biogas production

The Union Cabinet approved the GOBARDhan National Circular Bioenergy Scheme with a total financial outlay of Rs 23,731 crore. The scheme aims to transform organic waste into clean energy, create rural livelihoods, and drive economic growth. It will be implemented from FY 2026-27 to FY 2035-36 to scale up domestic compressed biogas production nearly ten-fold. City Gas Distribution entities must meet CBG blending obligations fixed at 3 percent for 2026-27, 4 percent for 2027-28, and 5 percent from 2028-29 onwards. The government introduced an administered CBG price of Rs 2,110 per MMBTU with a minimum tenure of ten years to ensure revenue certainty. Eligible greenfield projects will receive capital assistance of up to Rs 2 crore per tonne per day of installed capacity. A dedicated Credit Guarantee mechanism will improve access to institutional finance for MSME-based projects, cooperatives, and women entrepreneurs. A CBG Ecosystem Challenge Fund will support district-level planning, feedstock mapping, technology adoption, and capacity building.

When: FY 2026-27 to FY 2035-36 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Union Cabinet, Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas · **Prelims:** Total financial outlay of the scheme is Rs 23,731 crore.; Implementation period spans from FY 2026-27 to FY 2035-36.; Administered CBG price is set at Rs 2,110 per Metric Million British Thermal Unit.

Why it matters — Reduces India's dependence on imported fossil fuels and strengthens national energy security.; Creates alternative income streams for farmers through agricultural residue and cattle dung monetization.

Static — GOBARDhan (Galvanizing Organic Bio-Agro Resources Dhan) is an omnibus national initiative aimed at converting cattle dung and organic waste into compost, biogas, and bio-CNG. The scheme aligns with India's broader climate commitments to reduce carbon intensity and achieve net-zero emissions by 2070. The SATAT (Sustainable Alternative Towards Affordable Transportation) initiative was launched earlier to promote compressed biogas as an alternative green transport fuel.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Scheme, Data/Stats

[ddnews.gov.in: read the source](#)

GS2 GS3

MAKE NOTES

Cabinet approves continuation of PM-KISAN till 2030-31 with Rs. 3.15 lakh crore outlay

The Union Cabinet approved the continuation of the PM-KISAN scheme for the period from 2026-27 to 2030-31. The extended scheme has a total financial outlay of Rs. 3.15 lakh crore to provide ongoing income support to eligible farmers. The core issue is ensuring sustained financial well-being and reducing farmers' dependence on informal sources of credit. The scheme provides Rs. 6,000 annually to eligible landholding farmer families in three equal instalments via Direct Benefit Transfer. Aadhaar-based authentication and digital verification ensure transparent and technology-driven delivery of assistance. Over Rs. 4.47 lakh crore has been directly transferred to farmers through 23 instalments since the scheme's launch. Nearly one in every four beneficiaries is a woman farmer, who have collectively received over Rs. 1.06 lakh crore. An evaluation by NITI Aayog's DMEO found that 92 percent of beneficiaries used the funds for agricultural investments. The extension aims to maintain agricultural productivity, timely input purchases, and overall stability for rural households.

When: 2026-29-09 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Union Cabinet, Prime Minister Narendra Modi · **Prelims:** PM-KISAN provides Rs. 6,000 annually in three equal instalments.; The approved outlay for the extension till 2030-31 is Rs. 3.15 lakh crore.; Over 9.49 crore farmers received the 23rd instalment amounting to more than Rs. 18,984 crore.

Why it matters — Ensures regular income support and reduces dependence on informal money lenders for small and marginal farmers.; Leverages the Digital India framework through Aadhaar authentication and DBT to eliminate leakages.

Static — PM-KISAN is a Central Sector Scheme with 100% funding from the Government of India, operationalized since February 2019. It aims to supplement the financial needs of landholding farmers in procuring various inputs to ensure proper crop health. The responsibility of identifying eligible farmer families rests with the State and Union Territory governments.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Governance & Policy, Agriculture & Allied · Prelims angle: Scheme, Data/Stats

[ddnews.gov.in: read the source](https://ddnews.gov.in/read-the-source)

GS2

MAKE NOTES

Cabinet approves Rs 15,000 crore Covid-19 package

The Union Cabinet cleared the Rs 15,000 crore package for Covid-19. The Union Cabinet approved a Rs 15,000 crore financial package for Covid-19 management and health system preparedness.

When: 2026-09-29 · **Who:** Union Cabinet · **Prelims:** The approved Covid-19 package amount is Rs 15,000 crore.; The decision was approved by the Cabinet.

Why it matters — Crucial for strengthening India's medical infrastructure against pandemic threats.; Provides vital financial backing to states for managing public health emergencies.

Static — The Union Cabinet is the apex decision-making body of the executive in India, led by the Prime Minister. Financial packages during public health emergencies are typically routed through the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare. Disaster management and public health responses involve coordination between central ministries and state governments under relevant statutory frameworks.

Syllabus: GS2: Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Data/Stats

[Mumbai Mirror: read the source](https://mumbai-mirror.com/read-the-source)

International Relations

GS2

MAKE NOTES

EAM Jaishankar says India-China ties better today after border standoff resolution

External Affairs Minister Dr S Jaishankar stated that India-China relations are currently better than they were last year. This improvement occurred after the resolution of the border standoff between the two nations. India consistently conveyed to China that prolonged standoffs and bilateral dips do not serve the interests of either country. Regarding India-US trade talks, Jaishankar noted that both nations have reached an understanding on the trade agreement. He emphasized that trade negotiations require patience due to structural differences, noting India's vast population of small producers and small factories. He highlighted that tariffs created friction in the India-US relationship last year. On global security, Jaishankar noted a lack of sufficient US understanding or empathy regarding India's concerns about terrorism. He warned that the Russia-Ukraine and Iran-Gulf conflicts have devastated Global South economies, tightening energy markets and threatening food and fertiliser shortages.

When: 2026-09-29 · **Where:** New York · **Who:** Dr S Jaishankar · **Prelims:** The event where EAM Jaishankar spoke was organised by the Asia Society in New York.; Jaishankar noted that tariffs created a bump for India-US relations last year.; He stated that conflicts in Russia-Ukraine and Iran-Gulf have severely impacted Global South economies.

Why it matters — Reflects official diplomatic assessment of stabilization along the India-China border.; Clarifies India's negotiating stance and structural realities regarding trade agreements with developed nations like the US.

Static — India-China bilateral relations encompass deep historical ties, complex boundary disputes stemming from the colonial era, and growing economic interdependence. India-US relations have evolved into a comprehensive global strategic partnership involving defense, technology, trade, and regional security cooperation in the Indo-Pacific. The Global South refers to developing and emerging nations across Asia, Africa, and Latin America that face distinct economic and developmental vulnerabilities.

Syllabus: GS2: International Relations

[newsonair.gov.in: read the source](https://newsonair.gov.in/read-the-source) · also reported by ANI News

GS2 GS3

MAKE NOTES

India-Japan Summit 2026: PM Modi and Sanae Takaichi Sign Major AI, Defense Pacts

The signing of major AI and defense pacts during the India-Japan Summit 2026 put the bilateral relationship in the news. Indian Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Japanese counterpart Sanae Takaichi signed major agreements on artificial intelligence and defense during the India-Japan Summit 2026.

When: 2026-09-29 · **Who:** PM Narendra Modi and Sanae Takaichi · **Prelims:** The summit took place in 2026.; The leaders involved were PM Narendra Modi and Sanae Takaichi.; Major pacts were signed on AI and defense.

Why it matters — *Strengthens bilateral defense cooperation and technological collaboration in critical sectors like artificial intelligence.; Reinforces strategic stability and security cooperation in the Indo-Pacific region.*

Static — India and Japan established diplomatic relations in 1952, which were elevated to a Global and Strategic Partnership in 2006. Annual summit meetings between the Prime Ministers of India and Japan serve as the institutionalized mechanism for bilateral dialogue. The Quad (Quadrilateral Security Dialogue) includes India, Japan, the United States, and Australia, focusing on Indo-Pacific stability.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: International Relations, Science & Technology, Defence · Prelims angle: Agreement/MoU
theindianawaz.com: read the source

GS2

MAKE NOTES

India joins US China in WTO dispute over EU CBAM

India formally entered the ongoing WTO dispute against the EU's carbon border tax. India has joined the United States and China in challenging the European Union's Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism at the World Trade Organization.

When: 2026-09-29 · **Where:** Geneva / European Union / India · **Who:** India, US, China, European Union · **Prelims:** India joined the US and China in the WTO dispute.; The dispute targets the EU's CBAM.

Why it matters — *Highlights developing nations' resistance to unilateral green trade barriers.; Protects India's key manufacturing and export sectors from discriminatory tariffs.*

Static — The World Trade Organization is the sole global international organization dealing with the rules of trade between nations, established in 1995 under the Marrakesh Agreement. The WTO dispute settlement mechanism is a central pillar for stabilizing the global trading system, allowing member governments to resolve trade disputes. The European Union's Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism is designed to put a carbon price on imports of certain goods to prevent carbon leakage.

Syllabus: GS2: International Relations, Environment & Ecology
[NewsBytes: read the source](#) · [also reported by urbanacres.in](#)

GS2 GS3

MAKE NOTES

India stands as the First Responder, Preferred Security Partner in the Indian Ocean Region: Shri Rajnath Singh

Defence Minister Rajnath Singh addressed the second edition of the Indian Navy's biannual Commanders' Conference 2026 at Nausena Bhawan in New Delhi. He stated that India stands firm as the first responder and preferred security partner in the Indian Ocean Region. He noted that maritime complexity has increased due to congestion, deception, and gray-zone activities, requiring elevated monitoring and response mechanisms. He highlighted that Indian warships extend to the South China Sea, the Mediterranean, and the Atlantic Ocean, showing blue-water capability. Operation Urja Suraksha successfully ensured the safe transit of Indian-flagged merchant vessels and LPG tankers through the Strait of Hormuz during the West Asia crisis. India imports roughly 85 to 90 percent of its crude oil and about 50 percent of its natural gas via maritime routes. Recently commissioned warships feature over 75 percent indigenous content, showcasing domestic shipbuilding growth. The year 2026 is historic with plans to commission 18 warships, marking the largest single-year force accretion in naval history.

When: September 29, 2026 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Rajnath Singh · **Prelims:** The conference was held at Nausena Bhawan, New Delhi, on September 29, 2026.; India imports approximately 85-90% of its crude oil and around 50% of its natural gas through maritime routes.; Operation Urja Suraksha ensured safe transit of Indian-flagged merchant vessels and LPG tankers through the Strait of Hormuz.

Why it matters — *Reinforces India's strategic vision of being the first responder and preferred security partner in the Indian Ocean Region.; Highlights the growing success of domestic defence manufacturing with warships containing over 75% indigenous content.*

Static — The Indian Navy is the naval branch of the Indian Armed Forces, with the President of India serving as the Supreme Commander. The Indian Ocean Region is of vital geostrategic importance to India due to critical sea lanes of communication carrying energy and trade. Blue-water navy capability allows a force to project power far from its home country and operate openly across the open oceans.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: International Relations, Defence, Environment & Ecology
[PIB: read the source](#) · [free copy on greaterkashmir.com](#)

GS2

MAKE NOTES

India, Saudi Arabia review cooperation in defence, trade, energy and technology

India and Saudi Arabia reviewed their bilateral cooperation across multiple sectors including defence, security, trade, investment, energy, technology, healthcare and education. The bilateral review took place during a meeting between Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman and Saudi Finance Minister Mohammed Aljadaan on the sidelines of the AIIB Annual Meeting in Doha. Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman described Saudi Arabia as a trusted and valued strategic partner of India during their discussions. Both sides welcomed the successful conclusion of negotiations on the India-Saudi Arabia Bilateral Investment Treaty, which aims to provide a stronger and more predictable investment framework. In addition to Saudi Arabia, Ms. Sitharaman met Switzerland's AIIB Governor Ambassador Pietro Lazzeri to discuss investment opportunities through NIIF and GIFT IFSC. She also met Nepal's Finance Minister Swarnim Wagle to discuss flood recovery, bilateral projects, and the early operationalisation of the UPI-NPI digital payment linkage.

When: 2026-09-29 · **Where:** Doha · **Who:** Nirmala Sitharaman, Mohammed Aljadaan, Pietro Lazzeri, Swarnim Wagle · **Prelims:** The meeting between the Finance Ministers took place on the sidelines of the AIIB Annual Meeting in Doha.; The India-Saudi Arabia Bilateral Investment Treaty negotiations have successfully concluded.; Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman discussed investment opportunities in India through NIIF and GIFT IFSC with Switzerland's AIIB Governor.

Why it matters — Deepens bilateral economic and strategic engagement between India and Saudi Arabia through a formalized investment framework.; Expands financial cooperation and investment channels with global partners like Switzerland via NIIF and GIFT IFSC.

Static — The Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank (AIIB) is a multilateral development bank whose mission is to finance infrastructure for a sustainable future, with India being a founding member. Bilateral Investment Treaties (BITs) are international agreements between countries that establish terms and conditions for private investment by nationals and companies of one state in another state. The National Investment and Infrastructure Fund (NIIF) is India's strategically curated flagship infrastructure investment fund set up to foster infrastructure development.

Syllabus: GS2: International Relations, Defence

newsonair.gov.in: read the source

Health

GS2 GS3

MAKE NOTES

Supreme Court questions steep mark-ups on cancer drugs, calls pricing disparity 'carnage'

A petition was filed in the apex court seeking regulatory intervention to control the prices of drugs, medical equipment, and generic medicines. The Supreme Court expressed serious concern over excessive mark-ups on cancer medications, describing the pricing disparity as carnage. Petitioners seek the apex court's intervention in regulating the prices of drugs, medical equipment, and generic medicines, making them more affordable.

When: 2026-09-29 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Supreme Court, Petitioners · **Prelims:** The Supreme Court questioned steep mark-ups on cancer drugs.; Petitioners sought intervention in regulating prices of drugs, medical equipment, and generic medicines.

Why it matters — Highlights the critical issue of catastrophic health expenditures due to expensive cancer treatments.; Examines the effectiveness of existing drug price control mechanisms and regulatory enforcement.

Static — Drug price control in India is primarily administered under the Drugs Prices Control Order (DPCO), issued under the Essential Commodities Act. The National Pharmaceutical Pricing Authority (NPPA), established in 1997, fixes and revises prices of controlled bulk drugs and formulations. The Department of Pharmaceuticals under the Ministry of Chemicals and Fertilizers oversees pharmaceutical policy and price regulation in India.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Health, Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment

The Hindu: read the source

Economy

GS2 GS3

MAKE NOTES

Report of the Advisory Committee on Ways and Means Advances to State Governments

The RBI placed the newly submitted report of the Advisory Committee chaired by Shri I S N Prasad on its website. The Reserve Bank of India has published the report of the Advisory Committee on Ways and Means Advances to State Governments. The Reserve Bank had constituted an Advisory Committee, under the Chairmanship of Shri I S N Prasad, former Additional Chief Secretary, Government of Karnataka. The terms of reference of the Advisory Committee included, inter alia, review of State-wise WMA limits and other financial accommodation facilities available to the States. The Committee has made various recommendations which shall be examined by the Reserve Bank. (Brij Raj) Chief General Manager Press Release: 2026-2027/1211

When: 2026-09-29 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Shri I S N Prasad, Reserve Bank of India · **Prelims:** The Advisory Committee on WMA to State Governments was chaired by Shri I S N Prasad.; Shri I S N Prasad is the former Additional Chief Secretary of the Government of Karnataka.; The report reviews State-wise WMA limits and other financial accommodation facilities.

Why it matters — Helps state governments manage short-term liquidity mismatches efficiently without immediate distress borrowing.; Informs state-level fiscal management and federal financial architecture reviews by the Reserve Bank of India.

Static — Ways and Means Advances (WMA) are temporary loan facilities provided by the Reserve Bank of India to the central and state governments to help them match temporary mismatches in receipts and payments. The facility was introduced to help governments tide over cash flow mismatches without immediately resorting to overdrafts or market borrowings. The RBI acts as the banker to both the central and state governments under the provisions of the Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Economy · Prelims angle: Report/Index

[RBI: read the source](#) · [also reported by BusinessLine](#)

GS3

MAKE NOTES

Cabinet approves Rs 3,030 crore BHAVYA Rasayan scheme to set up three chemical parks

The Union Cabinet approved the Bharat Audyogik Vikas Yojana Rasayan scheme to set up three dedicated chemical parks. The scheme was announced in the Union Budget for 2026-27 to strengthen India's chemical manufacturing ecosystem. It has a total financial outlay of Rs 3,030 crore, spanning from FY 2026-27 to FY 2030-31. An amount of Rs 3,000 crore is allocated for infrastructure facilities, and Rs 30 crore for administrative expenses. The Centre will provide financial assistance of up to Rs 1,000 crore for each park, requiring at least Rs 500 crore from the state. Each chemical park requires a minimum of 2,000 acres of contiguous, encumbrance-free land selected via a challenge-based process. The parks will feature plug-and-play infrastructure including CETPs, TSDFs, water supply, and solvent recovery facilities. The initiative aims to promote sustainable industrial development, reduce logistics costs, and attract domestic and foreign investments.

When: FY 2026-27 to FY 2030-31 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Union Cabinet, Prime Minister Narendra Modi · **Prelims:** Total financial outlay of the BHAVYA Rasayan scheme is Rs 3,030 crore.; The scheme will be implemented over five years from FY 2026-27 to FY 2030-31.; Each chemical park requires at least 2,000 acres of contiguous land.

Why it matters — Strengthens India's chemical manufacturing ecosystem and reduces import dependence.; Promotes environmentally sustainable industrial development through centralized waste treatment.

Static — Chemical parks and petroleum, chemical and petrochemical investment regions (PCPIRs) serve as integrated manufacturing hubs designed to reduce operational and logistics costs. Common infrastructure in industrial clusters typically includes centralized effluent treatment plants, hazardous waste disposal, and shared utility networks. Plug-and-play infrastructure allows manufacturing units to commence operations quickly without investing heavily in foundational utilities independently.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Scheme, Data/Stats

[ddnews.gov.in: read the source](#)

GS3

MAKE NOTES

RBI drains \$20 billion liquidity via FX operations: What it means for rupee, rates

The Reserve Bank of India has soaked up an estimated \$20 billion of excess rupee liquidity through foreign exchange operations. The central bank utilized dollar-rupee sell-buy swaps, spot dollar sales, bond sales, and variable-rate reverse repos to manage liquidity. These liquidity tightening measures combined with seasonal tax outflows have more than halved the banking system's liquidity surplus. The banking system's liquidity surplus had previously touched a record 11.16 trillion rupees in the first week of September. Core liquidity dropped significantly from a peak of 14.2 trillion rupees on September 4 to 11.5 trillion rupees. Economists estimate that net RBI dollar sales of about \$18.5 billion through spot transactions and swaps drove the core liquidity decline. The RBI's sell-buy swaps pushed dollar-rupee forward premiums higher, raising hedging costs with the one-year premium up around 50 basis points. Governor Sanjay Malhotra had earlier indicated the central bank possesses multiple tools like bond sales and FX swaps to drain surplus liquidity.

When: September 2026 · **Where:** Mumbai, India · **Who:** Reserve Bank of India, Governor Sanjay Malhotra, Gaura Sengupta, Tanay Dalal · **Prelims:** The RBI drained an estimated \$20 billion of excess rupee liquidity through FX operations.; The banking system's liquidity surplus hit a record 11.16 trillion rupees in the first week of September.; Core liquidity fell to 11.5 trillion rupees from a peak of 14.2 trillion rupees on September 4.

Why it matters — Helps the central bank control inflationary pressures by removing excess cash from the banking system.; Demonstrates the growing importance of foreign exchange swaps as a core monetary management tool.

Static — The Reserve Bank of India is India's central banking institution, established on April 1, 1935, under the Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934. Liquidity management involves controlling the money supply in the banking system using tools like repo rates, reverse repos, open market operations, and cash reserve ratios. Foreign exchange swaps involve the simultaneous sale (or purchase) of spot foreign exchange against a forward purchase (or sale).

Syllabus: GS3: Economy

[Mint: read the source](#) · [free copy on msn.com](#)

GS3

MAKE NOTES

WIPO Global Innovation Index 2026: Switzerland, Sweden, US, Republic of Korea and Singapore Top Ranking; AI Reshaping Innovation Investments as Deep Science Startups Top \$7.6 Trillion

The release of the annual WIPO Global Innovation Index 2026 report highlighting global startup valuations and top-ranking economies. The World Intellectual Property Organization released the Global Innovation Index 2026, featuring Switzerland, Sweden, the US, South Korea, and Singapore at the top.

When: 2026 · **Who:** World Intellectual Property Organization · **Prelims:** Published by the World Intellectual Property Organization.; Top five economies in 2026: Switzerland, Sweden, United States, Republic of Korea, Singapore.; Deep science startups topped 7.6 trillion dollars.

Why it matters — Provides critical benchmarking for emerging economies like India to assess policy effectiveness in research and development.; Highlights major technological shifts such as artificial intelligence investments and deep science startup valuations.

Static — The Global Innovation Index is published annually by the World Intellectual Property Organization to rank world economies on their innovation ecosystems. WIPO is a specialized agency of the United Nations created in 1967 to promote and protect intellectual property worldwide. The index evaluates countries using numerous indicators spanning institutions, human capital, research, infrastructure, market sophistication, and business sophistication.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, International Relations, Science & Technology · Prelims angle: Report/Index

[World Intellectual Property Organization \(WIPO\): read the source](#) · also reported by [PIB](#)

GS3

MAKE NOTES

India's private investment declines even as project announcements more than double, despite record corporate profits

The trend was highlighted in a policy brief released by the National Institute of Public Finance and Policy in August 2026. India witnessed a decline in private investment despite a doubling of project announcements and record corporate profits, with firms choosing to accumulate cash instead of undertaking greenfield capital expenditure. Companies increasingly preferred to accumulate cash than undertake greenfield capital expenditure, NIPFP said in its August 2026 policy brief

When: August 2026 · **Where:** India · **Who:** National Institute of Public Finance and Policy (NIPFP) · **Prelims:** Project announcements more than doubled according to the NIPFP brief.; Corporate profits reached record levels during the period.; NIPFP released the relevant policy brief in August 2026.

Why it matters — Highlights a disconnect between corporate profitability and productive investment in the Indian economy.; Crucial for understanding macroeconomic stability, industrial growth, and employment generation prospects.

Static — Capital expenditure or capex refers to funds used by companies to acquire, upgrade, and maintain physical assets such as property, plants, buildings, or equipment. Greenfield investments are projects where a company builds new facilities from the ground up in a location where no previous facilities existed. Corporate savings and cash accumulation occur when firms retain earnings as cash or liquid assets instead of reinvesting them into productive economic capacity.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy

[Mint: read the source](#)

Environment & Ecology

GS3

MAKE NOTES

CAQM Approves Revised GRAP Schedule; Tightens Measures for Vehicles, Dust and Pollution Control

The Commission for Air Quality Management approved a revised Graded Response Action Plan schedule during its 30th full commission meeting. The revision formalises earlier ad-hoc orders by embedding stricter pollution-control measures directly into the permanent GRAP framework. Exemptions for BS-IV and below goods vehicles carrying essential commodities have been removed under Stages III and IV. The revised schedule now features a total of 48 actions across four distinct stages of air quality severity. Actions concerning diesel generator sets and the entry of BS-IV and below buses from adjoining states were shifted from Stage II to Stage I. Restrictions on plying BS-III petrol and BS-IV diesel four-wheelers were extended to Sonipat district in addition to existing high vehicle density districts. Web-portal registration and monitoring for dust control at construction and demolition sites were extended beyond municipal limits. State governments can implement directions beyond these federal mandates to better tackle regional air pollution.

When: 28.09.2026 · **Where:** National Capital Region · **Who:** Commission for Air Quality Management · **Prelims:** The revised GRAP schedule contains a total of 48 actions across four stages.; Restrictions on BS-III petrol and BS-IV diesel four-wheelers were extended to Sonipat.; The plot area threshold for construction and demolition site web monitoring remains unchanged at 500 square metres.

Why it matters — Closes loopholes by formalising ad-hoc vehicle bans into the core statutory GRAP framework.; Shifts critical emission controls to earlier, less severe stages to pre-empt peak winter pollution spikes.

Static — The Commission for Air Quality Management in National Capital Region and Adjoining Areas is a statutory body established under the Commission for Air Quality Management in National Capital Region and Adjoining Areas Act, 2021. It coordinates, plans, and takes steps to protect and improve air quality in the National Capital Region and adjoining areas, superseding multiple state-level committees. The Graded Response Action Plan is an emergency response framework implemented in phases based on the Air Quality Index levels in Delhi-NCR.

Syllabus: GS3: Environment & Ecology, Governance & Policy

[PIB: read the source](#) · [free copy on hindustantimes.com](#)

GS3

MAKE NOTES

Union Environment Minister hands over India's first PRAMAAN certificates under the Indian Forest and Wood Certification Scheme to Andhra Pradesh Forest Development Corporation and a Bamboo Farmer from Odisha

Union Environment Minister Bhupender Yadav handed over India's first PRAMAAN certificates under the Indian Forest and Wood Certification Scheme in New Delhi. The first certificates were given to the Andhra Pradesh Forest Development Corporation for 33,000 hectares of plantations and to bamboo farmer Govind Mohapatra from Odisha. The event was organized by the Indian Institute of Forest Management, Bhopal, which serves as the operating agency for the certification scheme. The certifications cover large-scale forest plantations and individual tree-based farming, marking the transition from policy to field-level implementation. PRAMAAN is the certification framework under IFWCS for forests, wood, and non-timber forest products to ensure sustainable management practices. Forest Management certification is assessed against the Indian Forest Management Standard, part of the National Working Plan Code 2023. The certification relies on independent third-party audits by bodies accredited by the National Accreditation Board for Certification Bodies under the Quality Council of India. The framework helps Indian producers and exporters meet international requirements like due diligence and deforestation-free timber sourcing. Several state departments, farmers, and industries have applied for certification across Forest Management, Tree Outside Forest Management, and Chain of Custody categories.

When: 2023 to 2026 · **Where:** New Delhi, Andhra Pradesh, Odisha · **Who:** Union Environment Minister Bhupender Yadav, Andhra Pradesh Forest Development Corporation, Govind Mohapatra, Indian Institute of Forest Management · **Prelims:** PRAMAAN stands for Programme for Recognition and Accreditation of sustainable Management practices for Agroforestry And Natural forestry resources.; The scheme was launched by the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change in December 2023.; The Indian Institute of Forest Management, Bhopal, is the operating agency for the certification scheme.

Why it matters — Positions India to meet international trade regulations such as deforestation-free timber sourcing norms.; Integrates small farmers, tribal communities, and women's self-help groups into a formal certification system.

Static — The Indian Forest and Wood Certification Scheme was launched in December 2023 by the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change to provide a national certification mechanism for forests, wood, and non-timber forest products. PRAMAAN stands for Programme for Recognition and Accreditation of sustainable Management practices for Agroforestry And Natural forestry resources. The National Accreditation Board for Certification Bodies under the Quality Council of India accredits certification bodies for conducting independent audits under the scheme.

Syllabus: GS3: Environment & Ecology, Governance & Policy, Agriculture & Allied · Prelims angle: Scheme

[PIB: read the source](#) · [free copy on indianmasterminds.com](#)

GS3

MAKE NOTES

Centre moves Supreme Court to stay hearings on Great Nicobar project

The Centre has moved the Supreme Court seeking a stay on further proceedings in petitions pending before the Calcutta High Court regarding the Great Nicobar Island project. The petition before the Calcutta High Court challenges the Rs 92,000-crore project over alleged violations of the Forest Rights Act, 2006, and flawed environmental approvals. Congress leader Jairam Ramesh criticized the Centre's move as an astonishing U-turn, alleging the project causes serious ecological damage. Five petitions filed by citizens and civil society groups are currently pending before the Calcutta High Court, with final hearings scheduled for November 25 and 26, 2026. The lead petitioner is Meena Gupta, a former senior official of both the Union Environment Ministry and the Tribal Affairs Ministry. The Centre argued before the Supreme Court that the petitioner has no locus standi and that the petitions are an abuse of process. The Calcutta High Court had earlier rejected the Centre's objection regarding the petitioner's locus standi and allowed the petitions to proceed. The Supreme Court is likely to hear the Centre's plea seeking a stay on October 5, 2026.

When: 2026-09-29 · **Where:** Great Nicobar Island and New Delhi · **Who:** Centre, Supreme Court, Calcutta High Court, Jairam Ramesh, Meena Gupta · **Prelims:** Cost of the Great Nicobar Island project: Rs 92,000 crore; Scheduled dates for final hearings in Calcutta High Court: November 25 and 26, 2026; Key petitioner: Meena Gupta (former senior official of Environment and Tribal Affairs Ministries)

Why it matters — Highlights the ongoing friction between developmental projects and environmental conservation in ecologically sensitive zones.; Tests judicial scrutiny over executive clearances and the implementation of the Forest Rights Act in remote island territories.

Static — The Great Nicobar Island Project is a massive infrastructural initiative aimed at holistic development, including a transshipment port, airport, power plant, and township. The Forest Rights Act (FRA), 2006 recognizes and vests forest rights and occupation in forest-dwelling Scheduled Tribes and traditional forest dwellers. Locus standi is a legal term referring to the right of a party to appear and be heard before a court of law.

Syllabus: GS3: Environment & Ecology, Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment

[The Hindu: read the source](#) · [free copy on msn.com](#)

Science & Technology

GS3

MAKE NOTES

NVS-03: Why India's armed forces eagerly await this navigation satellite from ISRO

ISRO is targeting the launch of the NVS-03 navigation satellite between October 15 and 20 to restore India's NavIC standalone positioning service. The NavIC service is currently inactive because only three operational navigation satellites remain in space, falling short of the mandatory four-satellite quorum. Without the fourth satellite, the armed forces cannot use NavIC for missile navigation, precise positioning, warship coordination, and indigenous combat support. ISRO has not launched a successful navigation satellite since NVS-01 on May 29, 2023, while the subsequent NVS-02 launched on January 29, 2025 failed to reach orbit. Union space minister Jitendra Singh informed Lok Sabha in July that NVS-04 and NVS-05 are already in an advanced stage of realisation. A successful NVS-03 launch will allow the constellation to pinpoint precise three-dimensional positions and correct time errors using atomic clocks. NavIC offers a standard positioning service for civilians and an encrypted restricted service exclusively for authorised users like the military.

When: Oct 15-20 · **Where:** India · **Who:** ISRO, Union Space Minister Jitendra Singh, Indian Armed Forces · **Prelims:** NVS-03 is targeted for launch between October 15 and 20.; NVS-01 was successfully launched on May 29, 2023.; NVS-02 failed to reach its intended orbit due to a pyro valve signal loss on January 29, 2025.

Why it matters — Restores strategic autonomy and tactical advantage for India's armed forces without relying on foreign-controlled networks.; Provides encrypted restricted service for missile navigation, precision-guided munitions, and troop coordination.

Static — NavIC (Navigation with Indian Constellation), formerly known as IRNSS, is India's regional satellite navigation system designed to provide accurate position information service. The system covers India and a region extending up to 1,500 km around it, providing both Standard Positioning Service and restricted encrypted service. A minimum of four satellites is required in a constellation to pinpoint a precise three-dimensional position and correct time errors in device clocks.

Syllabus: GS3: Science & Technology

timesofindia.indiatimes.com: read the source · also reported by dntext.in

Internal Security

GS3

MAKE NOTES

Amit Shah Unveils PRAHAAR Counter-Terrorism Policy

Union Home Minister Amit Shah unveiled PRAHAAR, India's first national counter-terrorism policy and strategy, on 23 February 2026. A conference on PRAHAAR was held in New Delhi on 28 September 2026 to discuss the framework as a 10-year institutional strategy. The policy rests on seven pillars: Prevention, Response, Aggregating Internal Capacities, Human Rights, Attenuating Conditions, Aligning International Efforts, and Recovery. It adopts a whole-of-society approach, emphasizing zero tolerance for terror and implementation right down to the police station level. Discussions at the September 2026 conference focused on achieving an automated counter-terrorism response at every level of administration. An Extradition Portal was launched on 28 September 2026 to coordinate and accelerate the repatriation of criminal fugitives to India. Between 2019 and 2026, 288 fugitive criminals were successfully repatriated to India from 36 different foreign countries. Over 40 modules of the Shahzad Bhatti network were busted, leading to over 100 FIRs, 350 arrests across 15 states, and its designation under UAPA.

When: 28 September 2026 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Union Home Minister Amit Shah · **Prelims:** PRAHAAR stands for Policy for Response Against Hostile Activities and Radicalism.; The 10-year counter-terrorism framework is built on seven key pillars.; An Extradition Portal was launched on 28 September 2026 to coordinate fugitive repatriations.

Why it matters — Provides India with its first unified, long-term national counter-terrorism strategy spanning a 10-year horizon.; Enhances international and domestic cooperation through dedicated tools like the new Extradition Portal.

Static — The Unlawful Activities Prevention Act of 1967 serves as India's principal legislative framework for tackling unlawful activities and designated terrorist organizations. Central Armed Police Forces and Central Police Organisations operate directly under the administrative control of the Union Ministry of Home Affairs. Extradition is a formal legal process where one sovereign state surrenders a wanted fugitive to another state for criminal prosecution or punishment.

Syllabus: GS3: Internal Security, Governance & Policy

gktoday.in: read the source · also reported by Ministry of External Affairs

PRELIMS FACTS

Concrete developments worth a quick read: exercises, pacts, Acts, approvals, schemes, species, verdicts.

SOCIAL JUSTICE & WELFARE

AGREEMENT/MOU

QUICK READ

Ministry of Tribal Affairs and IGNCA Sign MoU for Preservation, Documentation and Promotion of Tribal Cultural Heritage

The Ministry of Tribal Affairs and the Indira Gandhi National Centre for the Arts signed an MoU on September 28, 2026. The agreement aims to preserve, document, digitise, research, and promote India's diverse tribal tangible and intangible cultural heritage. The core issue is protecting vanishing tribal arts, music, languages, oral traditions, and traditional ecological knowledge from extinction.

[PIB: source](#)

ECONOMY

AGREEMENT/MOU

QUICK READ

Ministry of MSME and Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation Sign Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) for development and strengthening of the Statistical Business Register

The Ministry of MSME and the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation have signed an MoU to strengthen the Statistical Business Register. The agreement aims to institutionalize a structured framework and mechanism for sharing relevant data between both ministries. The core issue is improving the coverage, consistency, and reliability of business information used for economic and statistical purposes in India.

[PIB: source](#)

POLITY & CONSTITUTION

QUICK READ

M.P. Cabinet approves 20% quota for Agniveers in police, other uniformed services

The Madhya Pradesh Cabinet approved development proposals worth around Rs. 24,500 crore, covering infrastructure, health, education, and irrigation projects. The decisions were announced by Minister Chetanya Kashyap following a cabinet meeting on Tuesday. A key decision includes the launch of the Sugam Transport Scheme to establish an organised public transport system after a 21-year-old demand.

[The Hindu: source](#)

SOCIAL JUSTICE & WELFARE

REPORT/INDEX

APPOINTMENT

QUICK READ

Nine per cent of students report suicidal thoughts, finds Supreme Court-appointed panel's survey

A nationwide survey conducted by a Supreme Court-appointed panel found that about nine per cent of higher education students reported experiencing suicidal thoughts in the past year. The survey findings emerge amid renewed debate on student suicides following deaths at IIT Delhi and Bombay that caused widespread public outrage.

[Hindustan Times: source](#)

GOVERNANCE & POLICY

SCHEME

AGREEMENT/MOU

QUICK READ

NRIDA and IIM Kolkata Sign MoU for Four-Year Impact Assessment Study of PMGSY-IV and PM-JANMAN

NRIDA and IIM Kolkata signed a Memorandum of Understanding for a four-year longitudinal impact assessment study of rural roads. The study will assess the long-term outcomes of road infrastructure constructed under PMGSY-IV and PM-JANMAN schemes. The core issue is evaluating how rural road connectivity affects mobility, access to services, and overall socio-economic conditions over time.

[PIB: source](#)

ECONOMY

AGREEMENT/MOU

QUICK READ

Coal India signs non-binding MoU with HURL for urea production at Sindri

Coal India Limited and Hindustan Urvarak & Rasayan Limited signed a non-binding MoU on September 29, 2026. The MoU aims to explore developing a coal gasification-based ammonia-urea plant at HURL's Sindri facility in Jharkhand. The core issue is reducing India's dependence on imported natural gas and external feedstocks by utilizing domestic coal resources. The collaboration combines CIL's expertise in coal production with HURL's experience in large-scale fertilizer manufacturing.

[indianmasterminds.com: source](#)

ECONOMY

REPORT/INDEX

QUICK READ

Release of Sub-Sectoral Trial Index of Services Production (ISP) for July 2026 (Base Year 2024–25)

The Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI) released the fourth trial series of the Index of Services Production (ISP) for July 2026 with 2024-25 as the base year. Ten of the 19 tracked sub-sectors recorded double-digit year-on-year growth in July 2026, while seven others also expanded, indicating sustained momentum in formal services.

[PIB: source](#)

POLITY & CONSTITUTION

JUDGMENT

ACT/BILL/RULES

QUICK READ

Curative plea in SC flags alleged conflict, seeks recall of CEC Act split verdict

A curative plea has been filed in the Supreme Court seeking the recall of the September 23 split verdict on petitions challenging the CEC Act, 2023. The plea, filed by Dr Jaya Thakur, alleges a conflict of interest involving Justice Satish Chandra Sharma, who favored referring the matter to a larger bench.

[cnbctv18.com: source](#)

HISTORY, ART & CULTURE

QUICK READ

5 New Sites Added To India's UNESCO Tentative List For World Heritage

Five new sites and serial and transnational proposals were included in India's UNESCO Tentative List. This addition increases India's total count on the UNESCO Tentative List to 78. The newly added sites include the Buddhist murals of Bagh Cave Paintings and the Group of Temples of the Chambal Valley. Other additions are the Gupta-era Udaigiri Caves and the tribal legacy of Ginnorgarh.

[NDTV: source](#)

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY

QUICK READ

Delhi Pollution: Cabinet Approves 30 EV Road Sweepers, Real-Time PM2.5 And PM10 Monitoring With IIT Delhi

The Delhi Cabinet approved two major measures under the Winter Action Plan 2026-27 to strengthen pollution-control efforts ahead of winter. The trigger is the annual winter smog crisis driven by particulate matter and road dust. The core issue is tackling road-dust pollution on smaller roads and identifying real-time sources of PM2.5 and PM10.

[outlookindia.com: source](#)

INTERNAL SECURITY

ACT/BILL/RULES

QUICK READ

Implementation of Section 51A of UAPA, 1967: Updates to UNSC's 1267/ 1989 ISIL (Da'esh) & Al-Qaida Sanctions List: Amendment of 1 Entry

The RBI issued this notification to incorporate recent amendments made by the United Nations Security Council to its ISIL and Al-Qaida Sanctions List. The Reserve Bank of India issued an update regarding the implementation of Section 51A of the UAPA, 1967, following an amendment to an entry in the UNSC 1267/1989 ISIL and Al-Qaida Sanctions List.

[RBI: source](#)

GOVERNANCE & POLICY

QUICK READ

DGCA Introduces Training Framework for Gyroplane Pilots

The Directorate General of Civil Aviation introduced a new training framework via a Civil Aviation Requirement for gyroplane pilots. This regulatory step paves the way for the introduction, operationalisation, and licensing of gyroplanes in India. A gyroplane is a unique aircraft utilizing a freely rotating rotor system for lift and a propeller for forward thrust.

[PIB: source](#)

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

QUICK READ

India and Italy agree to strengthen bilateral cooperation in tourism

India and Italy held the 2nd India-Italy Joint Working Group on Tourism in Italy on 29 September 2026. The meeting was co-chaired by Shri Bhuvnesh Kumar, Secretary, Ministry of Tourism, India, and Ms. Emanuela Tripi, Secretary-General, Ministry of Tourism, Italy. Discussions focused on exchanging tourism data, promoting lesser-known destinations, cine-tourism, destination twinning, skilling, capacity building, and enhanced Business-to-Business engagement.

[PIB: source](#)

POLITY & CONSTITUTION

JUDGMENT

APPOINTMENT

QUICK READ

Supreme Court Reserves Verdict on Odisha DGP Appointment Case

The Supreme Court reserved its order on pleas challenging the selection process followed by the Odisha government for appointing the state's director general of police. The bench observed that most states tend not to follow the Prakash Singh judgment and try to avoid it to appoint a DGP of their choice.

[ptinews.com: source](#)

GOVERNANCE & POLICY

SCHEME

QUICK READ

Viksit Bharat- G RAM G

The VB-G RAM G Act, 2025 came into force on 1 July 2026, marking a seamless transition from Mahatma Gandhi NREGA. The government launched the Viksit Bharat - Guarantee for Rozgar and Aajeevika Mission (Gramin) (VB-G RAM G) Act, 2025, providing 125 days of guaranteed wage employment to rural households.

[PIB: source](#)

GOVERNANCE & POLICY

QUICK READ

UIDAI unveils five new initiatives at Aadhaar Samvaad Kolkata to further advance trusted digital identity and good governance

The Unique Identification Authority of India announced five digital identity initiatives at Aadhaar Samvaad in Kolkata on 29 September 2026. The event coincided with the 17th Aadhaar Day, marking the milestone of India's trusted digital identity infrastructure. The initiatives aim to enhance Aadhaar authentication, improve resident services, and support digital governance under the ecosystem.

[PIB: source](#)

HISTORY, ART & CULTURE

REPORT/INDEX

QUICK READ

Jaipur May Lose UNESCO World Heritage Status If Remedial Steps Not Taken By December: Rajasthan HC In Suo ...

The Rajasthan High Court took suo motu cognisance of the threat to the UNESCO World Heritage status of Jaipur's Walled City. Justice Pramil Kumar Mathur directed that the matter be placed before the Chief Justice for registration as a Public Interest Litigation. The Court warned that Jaipur could become the fifth World Heritage Site globally to lose its UNESCO status if corrective steps fail.

[lokmatimes.com: source](#)

SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY

AGREEMENT/MOU

QUICK READ

TDB signs agreement with Multi Nano Sense Technologies for Rs. 37.51 crore RDI support to build indigenous multi-gas sensing platform

The Technology Development Board signed an agreement with Nagpur-based Multi Nano Sense Technologies for financial support of Rs. 37.51 crore. The total approved cost of the multi-gas sensing platform project is Rs. 75.02 crore, supported through the Research Development and Innovation Fund via Optionally Convertible Debt. The core objective is to develop an indigenous platform combining MEMS sensors with CMOS application-specific analogue front-end system-on-chip electronics.

[PIB: source](#)

SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY

SCHEME

QUICK READ

ISRO Conducts National Meet on 'Scientific Exploration of the Moon through Chandrayaan Missions'

ISRO began a three-day national meet on the scientific exploration of the Moon through Chandrayaan missions at LEOS in Bengaluru on September 28, 2026. The meet gathered about 150 participants, including 75 from Indian academia and research institutes and 36 students pursuing lunar research. The meeting aims to engage the student community in building the future of India's space exploration programme and synergise national capabilities toward Space Vision 2040.

[isro.gov.in: source](#)

INFRASTRUCTURE & ENERGY

QUICK READ

Cabinet approves Rs 13,037 crore Jaipur Metro Phase-2 project to boost urban connectivity

The Union Cabinet approved the Jaipur Metro Phase-2 project to transform urban mobility in Rajasthan's capital. The project was initiated to expand public transit infrastructure, reduce traffic congestion, and lower vehicular emissions. The core debate centers on enhancing urban connectivity and economic viability through sustainable public transport investments. The project involves a 41-kilometre-long North-South metro corridor from Prahladpura to Todi Mod with 36 stations.

[ddnews.gov.in: source](#)

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY

REPORT/INDEX

QUICK READ

10 states have 14,468 springs, highest in Manipur: 1,336 here at risk; India's first-ever spring census

The release of data from India's first-ever spring census put the status and vulnerability of these water sources in the news. India completed its first-ever spring census, documenting 14,468 springs across 10 states with a high number at risk in Manipur.

[Bhaskar English: source](#)

INFRASTRUCTURE & ENERGY

QUICK READ

Cabinet approves Rs 3,630 crore revised cost for connectivity corridor to Jewar International Airport

The Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs approved a revised capital cost of Rs. 3,630.77 crore for a Greenfield connectivity corridor linking Noida International Airport to the Delhi-Mumbai Expressway. The project was greenlit by the CCEA chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Tuesday. The core issue involves providing seamless high-speed connectivity and boosting logistics efficiency across the National Capital Region.

[ddnews.gov.in: source](#)

INFRASTRUCTURE & ENERGY

SCHEME

AGREEMENT/MOU

QUICK READ

NX Group Signs Strategic Cooperation Memorandum with India Semiconductor Mission (ISM) to Develop Semiconductor Logistics Infrastructure in India

The strategic cooperation memorandum was signed to develop robust supply chain capabilities for India's emerging semiconductor sector. NX Group has signed a memorandum of cooperation with the India Semiconductor Mission to build specialized logistics infrastructure for semiconductors in India.

[The Manila Times: source](#)

EDITORIAL WATCH

What the opinion pages argued: two or three lines each.

GS2 UPSC Editorial Analysis: Freedom of Conscience vs. Mandatory Patriotism

The Supreme Court examined the constitutional validity of penal provisions concerning the mandatory singing of Vande Mataram, focusing on whether conscientious objection can invite criminal prosecution. The Court held that individuals cannot be penalized for declining to sing the National Song if it conflicts with their conscience or religious faith, provided they maintain a respectful posture. The Court distinguished between the executive power to notify official songs and its own duty to safeguard citizens from punitive overreach and constitutional rights violations.

[Insights on India](#)

GS3 Why bond yields are staying high

High long-term government bond yields have become a persistent global and domestic phenomenon despite declining inflation rates. Domestic yields are being driven by a combination of inflation expectations, fiscal concerns, tight monetary policy, and global factors. The core issue involves high government borrowing requirements and interest payments consuming around 37 per cent of total revenues. Rising global crude oil prices, geopolitical tensions, and high US Treasury yields create upward pressure on domestic bond yields.

[BusinessLine](#)

GS2 Towards a gender-just Uniform Civil Code

Union Home Minister Amit Shah stated on September 13 that a Uniform Civil Code (UCC) will be implemented across all BJP- and NDA-ruled states before the 2029 Lok Sabha elections. The author argues that while a UCC is justified through constitutional equality and gender justice, the Uttarakhand UCC conflates uniformity with equality and relies on bureaucratic hurdles. A central concern is the mandatory registration of live-in relationships requiring notification to police and parents, which acts as surveillance rather than protection.

[msn.com](#)

GS3 Why IRDAI should not back off now from its fight against insurance commissions

IRDAI has released a consultation paper offering reform proposals to address mis-selling in the insurance sector, with the most significant being a cap on agent, broker, and bank commissions. The regulatory proposals caused a stock market upheaval, demonstrating how heavily insurers and banks rely on high commission revenues and highlighting the expected industry pushback. Insurance agents typically earn upfront commissions upon sales and trail commissions annually, creating perverse incentives to push expensive endowment policies rather than consumer-friendly term covers.

[ThePrint](#)

GS2 The United Nations' long road to restoring trust

The 81st UNGA high-level week met under the theme of restoring trust, acknowledging a deep collapse in global confidence in the UN. Global surveys by Edelman Trust, Pew, and the UN Foundation show 52 per cent want deep structural reform and only 58 per cent trust UN leadership. The author argues that the UN's crisis of trust stems from its governance structure, funding vulnerabilities, and accountability gaps rather than failed delivery alone.

[The Hindu](#)

GS3 Digital agriculture and the problem of exclusion

It is in the news due to ongoing debates on the effectiveness and accessibility of technology-driven agricultural reforms. The editorial discusses the inclusion challenges facing digital agriculture in India and stresses the need to improve digital literacy for farm schemes to succeed. The DAM architecture risks excluding women and tenant farmers, and gives little attention to workers disrupted by tech change

[BusinessLine](#)

GS2 UPSC Editorial Analysis: Constitutional Safeguards on Arrest and Re-Arrest

The Supreme Court reaffirmed personal liberty over police discretion in *Jaskaran Jeet Singh Deol v. State of Punjab*, 2026. The Court ruled that communicating arrest grounds in writing, in a language understood by the accused, is mandatory under Article 22(1). It addressed the core dilemma of balancing citizen freedom against the state's power to investigate crimes. Section 47 of the BNSS, 2023 requires full particulars of the offense and the right to bail to be disclosed.

[Insights on India](#)

GS2 The great Indian trust bust: Why GoI shouldn't simply defend SIR numbers, but demand explanations

Public trust in India's electoral process faces severe erosion due to controversial implementation and flaws in the Special Information/Revision (SIR) process and the CEC's conduct. The Calcutta High Court pulled up the EC over handling a TMC symbol dispute, suggesting connivance, while the Supreme Court agreed to hear a petition questioning CEC Gyanesh Kumar's functioning. The India Today-CVoter Mood of the Nation survey shows the share of Indians believing elections are free and fair fell from 64.4% to 51.9% over the past year.

[Economic Times](#)

GS2 [The Opinionated Lawyer] Free and Fair: Elections and Election Commission

On September 23rd, 2026, a Supreme Court two-judge bench referred the question of a Constitution Bench reference on the 2023 Election Commissioners Act to the Chief Justice of India. Simultaneously, media reports revealed that the Election Commission faces internal friction, with the two Election Commissioners objecting 14 times to decisions by the Chief Election Commissioner. The core debate centers on whether the statutory appointment mechanism under the 2023 Act compromises the institutional independence of the Election Commission of India.

[Bar & Bench](#)

GS2 Yogendra Yadav writes: With its press note, the Election Commission makes the case against itself

The author argues that the Election Commission's press note dated September 26 is a formal admission of guilt and a sound legal basis to impeach the Chief Election Commissioner and other ECs. The ECI admitted in its note that agenda will be circulated in advance and minutes will be issued for all meetings, confirming that business was conducted without basic procedures for a year.

[msn.com](#)

GS3 RBI's capital cushion tweak: Tighter norms don't relieve banks of their need to track market risks

The RBI issued latest directions regarding prudential cushions that compel banks to maintain larger capital reserves. The Reserve Bank of India's (RBI) latest directions will require prudential cushions to expand but banks mustn't let their internal risk management slacken. The comfort of an extra capital buffer may prove pointless if lenders leave safety to regulation.

[Mint](#)

GS1 Give me land, lots of land: When farmland, forests and tribal land become political prizes

The persistent debate over land acquisition policies, industrialization pressures, and the protection of tribal and agrarian rights. An editorial discussing the socio-political dynamics of land acquisition, focusing on how farmland, forests, and tribal lands become contested political prizes.

[Deccan Herald](#)

GS3 Kaushik Basu: Is an AI-pocalypse inevitable? Not if we curb Big Tech's concentrations of wealth

The author argues that the existential risks and power-grabbing potential of artificial intelligence can be mitigated by using tax policies to curb the extreme concentration of wealth in Big Tech. Amid an accelerating AI race between the US and China, fears of rogue bots and anxiety over human extinction, attention has shifted to what the tech may do to us rather than for us. A tax policy that reduces concentrations of financial clout would limit the risk of AI being deployed for a power grab

[Mint](#)

GS2 The Gandhi test for the ECI: Disagreement and the courage to own up

The piece appeared as an opinion piece in Deccan Herald discussing institutional integrity. The editorial examines the Election Commission of India through the lens of Mahatma Gandhi's principles, emphasizing transparency and the courage to accept internal dissent. The Gandhi test for the ECI: Disagreement and the courage to own up

[Deccan Herald](#)

GS2 GS3 Rare diseases can be treated with tailored gene therapy but India's regulatory system must evolve

The need to review and adapt regulatory frameworks for modern medical technologies like gene therapy and AI. The editorial discusses the necessity for India's regulatory system to evolve in order to accommodate advanced therapeutic paths like AI and Crispr gene editing for rare diseases. India should review its regulation of new therapeutic paths enabled by tech advances. Safe ways exist to test modern therapies in a country that's well placed to make breakthroughs.

[Mint](#)

EXPLAINED

The concept behind the news, one or two lines each.

ECINET, ERONET: What are the Election Commission's electoral roll systems? The systems are in focus due to ongoing administrative updates and discussions surrounding digital electoral roll management. ECINET and ERONET are digital IT systems used by the Election Commission of India for electoral roll management and voter registration.

[Indian Express](#)

Why has Maharashtra declared drought in 265 talukas and what do farmers get? The state government announced the drought declaration as the monsoon concluded with only five districts recording average or above-average rainfall. Maharashtra has declared a drought in 265 talukas following a significant shortfall in rainfall as the monsoon comes to an end.

[The Hindu](#)

Why Rayalaseema farmers fear a bumper crop more than drought; can the Rs. 1-lakh-crore horticulture hub change that? The persistent vulnerability of Rayalaseema farmers during high-yield seasons has brought focus to the proposed Rs. 1-lakh-crore horticulture hub. Rayalaseema farmers fear bumper agricultural yields due to the absence of cold storage, poor market linkages, and middleman exploitation.

[The Hindu](#)

Food Loss & Waste – Causes & Consequences Up to 40% of food produced in India is lost before reaching consumers, with 30-50% of perishable produce spoiling due to poor cold-chain infrastructure. Post-harvest losses stem from inadequate storage, weak cold chains, poor handling, inefficient transportation, and fragmented supply chains with multiple intermediaries.

[ForumIAS](#)

Is the U.S. taking the upper hand in the battle of Hormuz? The ongoing stalemate over the Strait of Hormuz has prompted the U.S. to push for bringing the nuclear file back into negotiations. An explainer on the diplomatic and strategic dynamics involving the U.S., Iran, the Strait of Hormuz, and nuclear negotiations.

[The Hindu](#)

Knowledge Nugget | PRAHAAR: Why India's national counter-terrorism strategy matters? It is featured as a knowledge nugget for UPSC civil services aspirants to understand India's security architecture. This explainer details the significance of PRAHAAR as India's national counter-terrorism strategy for internal security.

[Indian Express](#)

China's '10 million tonnes' US coal bet is about more than energy: What Beijing gets from trade deal China is set to increase US coal imports under a September 2026 trade agreement designed to ease bilateral tensions. The US stated China committed to buying at least 10 million tonnes of US coal annually in 2027 and 2028, though Beijing has not confirmed this volume.

[Mint](#)

How merging Tata Electronics, TCE could help Tata Sons avoid an RBI-mandated listing The story is in the news because of Tata Sons' strategy to navigate the Reserve Bank of India's Upper Layer NBFC listing mandate. Tata Sons is considering the merger of Tata Electronics and Tata Consulting Engineers to restructure its finances and escape the RBI's mandatory public listing requirement.

[Indian Express](#)

Can solar power help the White Revolution break new ground? It highlights the geographical concentration of milk production and proposes solar energy as a solution for regional expansion. The article explores how deploying solar-powered chilling infrastructure can expand India's White Revolution into underserved regions. India leads the world in milk production, but output is concentrated in a handful of States.

[Frontline](#)

How can India reconcile its large domestic demand for gold with the need to contain external-sector vulnerabilities? Examine the potential of recycling and mobilisation of existing gold stocks. What constraints limit their effectiveness? India faces persistent domestic demand for gold that impacts external sector stability and drives up import dependence. The core issue is balancing high gold demand with external vulnerabilities by utilizing accumulated domestic gold as a productive economic resource. Financial alternatives, recycling, old-gold exchange, and domestic value addition can reduce dependence on incremental gold imports.

[Insights on India](#)

Essar eyes \$18-billion US steel plant: Why Indian firms are investing in US amid tariffs India's Essar Group is planning an \$18 billion steel plant and mining project in the US through its subsidiary Mesabi Metallics. The major investment is driven by the Trump administration's 50% tariff on imported foreign steel, which incentivizes domestic manufacturing.

[msn.com](#)

Heart attacks in fit women in their 30s and 40s: The hidden risk doctors want you to know Increasing medical attention on cardiac events occurring in young, physically fit women. An explainer on the hidden cardiovascular risks leading to heart attacks in fit women aged in their 30s and 40s.

[Indian Express](#)

ALSO IN THE NEWS

Reactions, previews and smaller stories: one line each.

- Trade agreement can contribute to 'better' India-US ties, says Jaishankar as Piyush Goyal set to hold talks (International Relations) [Hindustan Times](#)
- RBI may face two hikes, one dilemma as repo rate is seen hitting 5.75% soon: Report (Economy) [Economic Times](#)
- Lack of understanding about cross-border terror concerns impacts bilateral ties: Jaishankar on India-U.S. relations (International Relations) [The Hindu](#)
- Supreme Court to hear plea raising doubts over CEC Gyanesh Kumar's decisions next week (Polity & Constitution) [Hindustan Times](#)
- India rejects Kashmir references in Turkish President's UNGA address as 'unwarranted' (International Relations) [The Hindu](#)
- Govt lowers foodgrain production target by 2.63 mn tonnes for 2026-27 over El Nino fears (Agriculture & Allied) [BusinessLine](#)
- CISF Signs MoUs for Cyber Security and Anti-Drone Capabilities (Internal Security) [Drishti IAS](#)
- India joins SCO meeting in Islamabad to prepare for 2027 leaders' summit (International Relations) [The Economic Times](#)
- Months after Himachal Pradesh HC quashed ESZ notification around Simbalbara park, stone crushers resume operations (Environment & Ecology) [The Indian Express](#)
- Quad launches Indo-Pacific energy security initiative amid global market concerns (International Relations) [DD News](#)
- EAM Jaishankar warns of 'major food crisis' in coming months (Economy) [The Hindu](#)
- Union Minister of Culture and Tourism Shri Gajendra Singh Shekhawat Felicitates 20 Award-Winning Artists at National Exhibition of Arts (History, Art & Culture) [PIB](#)
- Literacy for All (Education) [PIB](#)
- Party-appointed BLAs bypass ECI cap for 10 applications a day through its own portal for deletions (Polity & Constitution) [The Hindu](#)
- Indian, ASEAN navies participate in second ASEAN-India Maritime Exercise in Philippines (International Relations) [All India Radio \(NewsOnAir\)](#)
- Megamalai forest encroachment case: SC reserves judgment, questions Ilavam Panju plantations (Environment & Ecology) [The South First](#)
- Ministry of Mines to Launch Auction of Offshore Mineral Blocks in Andaman Sea (Economy) [PIB](#)
- India sends senior MEA official to Pakistan for SCO coordinators meet (International Relations) [Indian Express](#)

- Maruti Suzuki Commissions 300 kW Green Hydrogen Plant at Manesar (Environment & Ecology) [Drishti IAS](#)
- INDIAN NAVAL SHIP TARKASH ARRIVES AT MOMBASA, KENYA FOR GOODWILL PORT CALL (International Relations) [PIB](#)
- Ministry of Minority Affairs Signs MoUs with IISc, IIM Bangalore and IIT Madras (Governance & Policy) [Drishti IAS](#)
- UN chief to stress multipolarity, UNSC reforms at BRICS Summit in India (International Relations) [ddnews.gov.in](#)
- India's semiconductor market projected to cross USD 200 billion by 2035: EY-IESA report (Economy) [DD News](#)
- New deep-water conger eel species discovered off Kerala's coast, named after CMFRI (Environment & Ecology) [Research Matters](#)
- Nepal's flash floods: How can communities rebuild after a disaster? (Disaster Management) [The Hindu](#)
- BRICS Women Ministerial Meeting begins in Kochi, adopts joint statement on women-led development (Social Justice & Welfare) [DD News](#)
- NGT Rules Against Every Petitioner in Six Months, Report (Environment & Ecology) [groundreport.in](#)
- Patent Term Adjustment For Grant Delay: Supreme Court Issues Notice On Section 53 Patents Act Challenge (Polity & Constitution) [lawchakra.in](#)
- GI tag for Tripura's tribal musical instrument strengthens push to preserve indigenous culture (History, Art & Culture) [DD News](#)
- BRICS New Delhi Declaration (International Relations) [The Times of India](#)
- NITI Aayog report on reimagining skilling for Viksit Bharat – resetting the debate on educated unemployment.. (Education) [ET Education](#)
- GIPE shadow monetary policy panel flags partial RBI rate cut transmission, bats for status quo as food & (Economy) [The Times of India](#)
- US awards \$21 billion missile contract to RTX's Raytheon as it looks to replenish stocks amid ongoing conflict with Iran (Defence) [Economic Times](#)
- Population of India 2026: Statewise Data, Demographics & Forecast (Society) [NEXT IAS](#)
- India to have more older population set as fertility falls below replacement: Moody's (Social Justice & Welfare) [Economic Times](#)
- UAE signals another \$25 billion investment in India; eyes ports, energy and space sectors: Goyal (International Relations) [The Hindu](#)
- What is the Inter-Tropical Convergence Zone? Explain the factors responsible for its seasonal migration. Analyse its influence on tropical rainfall and monsoonal circulation. (Geography) [Insights on India](#)
- PM Modi, Prabowo expand India-Indonesia defence, maritime and cyber security ties (International Relations) [ddnews.gov.in](#)
- India, Brazil and South Africa Back Permanent African Seat as IBSA Demands Time-Bound UN Security Council Reform (International Relations) [thevoiceofafrica.com](#)
- Govt mandates QR codes for vaccines, antimicrobials, cancer drugs to curb counterfeit medicines (Health) [DD News](#)
- Ex-Home Secretary R.K. Singh accuses CEC Gyanesh Kumar of 'illegalities' in SIR, calls for Opposition unity (Polity & Constitution) [The Hindu](#)
- mmdr amendment act (Economy) [Down To Earth](#)
- Supreme Court Upholds Ban on Mining Activities in Meghalaya — Environmental Protection Measures Enforced. (Environment & Ecology) [Lawtext](#)
- Solid Waste Management rules (SWM rules) 2026 (Environment & Ecology) [Down To Earth](#)
- Shram Samvad: Govt to launch nationwide awareness campaign on four labour codes (Governance & Policy) [Hindustan Times](#)
- Progress in women safety post Nirbhaya questionable: Supreme Court orders vulnerable-area mapping, more CCTVs, lighting, police patrol (Social Justice & Welfare) [Bar & Bench](#)
- "Organisational wrongdoing often survives because responsibility is dispersed across several actors." Explain the role of diffusion of responsibility in facilitating unethical conduct. How can individual accountability be preserved? (Ethics & Integrity) [Insights on India](#)
- Judicial responses to climate change: Constitutionalising right to clean environment and protection against effects of climate change (Environment & Ecology) [Bar & Bench](#)
- MHA officials arrested for allegedly seeking bribe to facilitate FCRA registration (Polity & Constitution) [Times of India](#)

COVERAGE CHECK

Items — 22 must-know, 23 Prelims facts, 49 in the news, 15 editorials, 12 explainers.

Syllabus areas in the cards — Economy (8), Governance & Policy (7), International Relations (6), Polity & Constitution (6), Environment & Ecology (5), Science & Technology (3), Infrastructure & Energy (3), Internal Security (2), Social Justice & Welfare (2), History, Art & Culture (2), Health (1). **Nothing today in** — Education, Agriculture & Allied, Defence, Disaster Management, Geography, Society, Ethics & Integrity.

Easy-miss watch — Marine & coastal (EEZ, UNCLOS, Blue Economy, deep sea): 4 · Digital Public Infrastructure & data governance: 1 · Political change in the neighbourhood: nothing today · Appointments to constitutional / statutory / regulatory bodies: nothing today · Defence-technology cooperation agreements: 1

Full text — 46 of 72 items were read in full from a free copy; the rest are summarised from the outlets' reports. Subscriber-only sites are never opened.

Sources in the cards — PIB 12, The Hindu 7, Mint 6, ddnews.gov.in 5, Indian Express 4, Insights on India 3, msn.com 3, RBI 2, newsonair.gov.in 2, Bar & Bench 2, BusinessLine 2, Deccan Herald 2, theindianawaz.com 1, Mumbai Mirror 1

Built 04 Oct 2026, 00:10 IST by UPSC Intel. Notes quote the reports; check the source before quoting a figure in an answer.